

IOT6002U Assessment Brief – 003

Professional Showcase

Module Code	IOT6002U
Module Title	Research Informed Professional Practice
Module Organiser(s)	Jonathan Jackson & Alex Cline
Assessment	003 Professional Showcase
Weighting (%)	40%
Deadline	Friday 19 th February 2027, 23:59
Duration / Length	Upwards of 30 hours effort

Assessment Outline

The purpose of this assessment is to demonstrate how you are developing an emerging professional reputation through the sharing of research-informed knowledge, insights, experiences, recommendations, or good practice.

As a Digital and Technology Solutions Professional, technical expertise alone is not sufficient. Professionals are expected to communicate effectively, contribute to the development of others, share good practice, and continue developing their own knowledge and skills throughout their careers.

This assessment focuses on your ability to establish yourself as a credible professional who can communicate valuable insights to others in an appropriate and professional manner.

Assessment Task

For this assessment, you will create a professional showcase in a format of your choice that communicates knowledge, insights, experiences, recommendations, lessons learned, or research-informed findings to an audience relevant to your professional context.

You may choose to build upon the work completed for Assessment 002 (Research Output), although this is not required.

Alternatively, you may focus on another area of professional expertise, workplace learning, project experience, emerging technology, innovation, professional interest, or specialist topic that is relevant to your apprenticeship pathway.

You are **not** expected to conduct additional research for this assessment. The focus is on sharing knowledge professionally and demonstrating your ability to contribute to the development of others (B5, B6).

Example Audiences and Formats

The audience and format are flexible and should be appropriate to your chosen topic. Examples are given below.

Audience	Example Deliverable
Senior leaders	Executive briefing
Technical team	Technical presentation
New apprentices	Training session
Workplace colleagues	Lunch-and-learn session
Customers or users	Webinar or explainer session
Professional community	Conference-style presentation
General public	Professional podcast or video
Digital practitioners	Professional article, blog post or website

Alternative audiences and formats may be proposed and agreed through discussion with your module tutor to ensure it will enable you to satisfy the requirements of the assessment brief.

Submission Requirements

You should submit a single document (.pdf or .docx) which is not password protected. Within this document, you should include the following

Part A – Professional Showcase Artefact

Create one non-trivial professional showcase artefact based on research you have already conducted and evidence this in a manner appropriate to the format (e.g. link to a video, full text of an article, link and transcript of podcast, screenshots of slides, etc...)

Examples may include:

- Recorded presentation
- Webinar
- Training session
- Podcast episode
- Professional video
- Professional article
- Blog post
- Opinion piece / Op-ed
- Professional website
- Technical briefing
- Executive briefing
- Conference-style presentation
- Recorded workshop

You may use another format if appropriate to the intended audience but you should discuss this with your module tutor before proceeding to ensure it is appropriate.

Part B – Evidence of Dissemination and Impact

Provide evidence that the showcase has been shared, delivered, published, or prepared for wider dissemination at a later date. As a minimum, you must provide evidence that at least some relevant individuals have seen your showcase.

Ensure you consider compliance or privacy constraints before planning this part of the assessment. If you cannot share evidence of internal organisation dissemination, it would be prudent to evidence dissemination via another channel.

Examples of appropriate evidence may include one or several of the following:

- Screenshot or link to publication
- Link and/or screenshot of a LinkedIn or Substack post
- Internal workplace communication
- Teams or Slack message
- Event invitation
- Attendance record
- Audience feedback – particularly useful for demonstrating qualitative impact
- Distribution email
- Screenshot evidence of submitting an article to a journal or website
- Screenshot evidence of upload to an internal knowledge-sharing platform

If linking to external resources, ensure they are publicly available. Resources that cannot be accessed will be ignored and not be considered acceptable evidence.

You are **not** being assessed on audience size, popularity metrics, seniority of audience members, or organisational prestige.

Alongside your evidence of dissemination and potential impact, include explanations and justifications of your approach (no word count limit).

Work shared internally, publicly, or within a simulated environment will all be assessed on the same basis, as per the assessment criteria at the end of this document.

Part C – Professional Reflection (up to 500 words)

Provide a short reflection explaining the following, which you can also use as a basis for discussion with your apprenticeship skills coach as part of your ongoing professional development:

- Why the format was appropriate for the audience
- How you adapted the material for the audience. Be specific and give examples.
- What you learned from the process. Identify a specific moment of learning and what lesson(s) you took from it.
- How the activity contributed to your professional development and how you might build on this in the future to build your own reputation and help support others.

We are not looking for a “right answer” in your reflection, and you do not need to adhere to a specific reflective model. Instead, we are looking for evidence that you made the most of this assessment to develop yourselves personally and professionally.

You should review the “Assessment Criteria” at the end of this document to understand how your work will be marked.

Generative AI guidance

AMBER (permitted)

Use of Generative AI (e.g., MS Copilot or ChatGPT) is **permitted** for this assessment, but not required. If using spelling or grammar assistive tools, be cautious if using any Generative AI features which rewrite non-trivial portions of your work in case your original meaning is lost or your writing ends up being incoherent. You remain fully responsible for the work you submit.

Avoid relying on Generative AI to format your references as these tools can often produce references which do not exist which will significantly undermine the credibility of your work and may be considered academic misconduct. Dedicated reference management tools such as EndNote, Zotero or Mendeley can provide more reliable support for this task.

The following are examples of potential uses of GenAI that would be considered **appropriate** for this assessment:

✓ Creating slides, diagrams, visuals or infographics	Using AI to generate or refine visual representations based on your own content, analysis, or interpretation. Your responsibility: You remain responsible for the accuracy, meaning, and interpretation of any visual material submitted.
✓ Exploring ideas	Using AI as a prompt, critical friend, or sounding board to explore ideas, perspectives, or alternative approaches for your professional showcase. Your responsibility: You remain responsible for expressing ideas in your own way and for acknowledging the ideas of others where appropriate.
✓ Checking and/or improving spelling, grammar and punctuation	Using AI as a proofreading or editing aid to identify spelling, grammar, punctuation, or typographical errors. Your responsibility: You remain responsible for ensuring that any suggested changes accurately reflect your intended meaning and do not introduce new content or ideas.
✓ Improving clarity and readability	Using AI to suggest clearer phrasing, improve expression, or enhance the readability of text. Your responsibility: You remain responsible for the meaning, argument, and interpretation presented in your work.

If you are in doubt about the appropriateness of using any specific assistive technology, please discuss with your module organiser.

For more guidance, please see <https://www.qmul.ac.uk/library/academic-skills/student-guide-to-generative-ai/>.

Late Submissions and Extenuating Circumstances

Assessments submitted after the published deadline will be marked as late and will receive a penalty, unless you have approved Extenuating Circumstances (EC).

You may submit up to seven calendar days after the deadline but a penalty of 5% of the total marks available will be applied to the assessment for each 24-hour period (or part of it) that the work is late (e.g. five marks deducted each day from a total of 100). After seven calendar days the assessment will be recorded as a non-submission and given a mark of zero.

Late penalties are applied automatically so please be aware that even submitting 10 seconds late (e.g. 23:59:10) will trigger a late penalty.

For more information, you can find the latest Assessment Handbook and Extenuating Circumstances policy via the QMUL policies page here: <https://www.qmul.ac.uk/governance-and-legal-services/policy/policies-by-category/>

Knowledge, Skills, and Behaviours (Apprenticeship v1.2)

The nature of this assessment means that many different KSBs may be covered depending on your apprenticeship specialism and choice of research topic. Nonetheless, the following KSBs are closely aligned:

- S13 – Report effectively to colleagues and stakeholders using the appropriate language and style, to meet the needs of the audience concerned.
- B5 – Interacts professionally with people from technical and non-technical backgrounds. Presents data and conclusions in an evidently truthful, concise and appropriate manner.
- B6 – Participates in and shares best practice in their organisation, and the wider community for aspects relevant to digital and technology solutions.
- B7 – Maintains awareness of trends and innovations in the subject area, utilising a range of academic literature, online sources, community interaction, conference attendance and other methods which can deliver business value.

Assessment Criteria

Criteria	0-29 (F) Not successful	30-39 (E) Below required standard	40-49 (D) Pass	50-59 (C) Satisfactory	60-69 (B) Good	70-79 (A) Excellent	80-100 (A+) Outstanding
Minimum pass requirement	Students must submit a single accessible .docx or .pdf document containing the showcase artefact or evidence of it, evidence of dissemination or preparation for dissemination, and the professional reflection. Submissions which are password protected, zip files, or which circumvent Turnitin plagiarism checks in any way will result in a fail (0). All assessment criteria must be passed to be able to pass the overall assessment.						
Professional Showcase Artefact (25%)	Not attempted, incoherent, inaccessible, or unrelated to a relevant professional context.	The artefact is poorly scoped, difficult to follow, or weakly connected to the intended professional context, topic, or audience.	A basic artefact is submitted and communicates some relevant knowledge. Quality, structure, accuracy, or professional relevance may be uneven or underdeveloped.	The showcase is relevant, mostly accurate, and usable for the intended professional purpose. Demonstrates some appropriate use of research-informed material. May contain some errors or omissions.	The showcase is clear, credible, well structured, and professionally presented. Translates research-informed material into useful insights or recommendations for the audience. (B6, B7) Minimal errors or omissions.	In addition to B-grade criteria: The showcase is polished, engaging, and shows strong professional judgement in its selection, interpretation, and presentation of material.	In addition to A-grade criteria: Exceptional quality, originality, or professional value. Clear potential for wider use, reuse, or influence. Goes beyond the essential requirements of the brief.
Dissemination and Impact (25%)	Not attempted, missing, inaccessible, or not connected to the submitted showcase. No evidence that the showcase was seen by any relevant individuals.	Evidence of dissemination or preparation for dissemination is limited, unclear, inaccessible, or weakly connected to a relevant audience.	Some evidence that the showcase artefact was shared, delivered, published, or prepared for wider dissemination. At least some evidence that the showcase was seen by more than one relevant individual.	Evidence is mostly clear and accessible, showing that the showcase was shared, delivered, or published for a relevant audience. There is some indication of how the activity contributed to others' learning, practice, or awareness.	Evidence is clear, accessible, and appropriate to the chosen dissemination route. The showcase is shared with others in a professional manner, appropriate to the context. (B5) Clear evidence of contributing to others' learning, practice, or awareness e.g. via positive feedback.	In addition to B-grade criteria: The dissemination approach is well judged and shows strong awareness of audience access, professional constraints, privacy, compliance, or reputational considerations.	In addition to A-grade criteria: Ambitious in reach, positioning, or professional value, and demonstrates clear potential to benefit a workplace, professional community, or wider audience. Careful consideration given to multiple dissemination channels.

Assessment Criteria

Criteria	0-29 (F) Not successful	30-39 (E) Below required standard	40-49 (D) Pass	50-59 (C) Satisfactory	60-69 (B) Good	70-79 (A) Excellent	80-100 (A+) Outstanding
Audience Adaptation (25%)	Not attempted, inaccessible, incoherent, or wholly inappropriate for the intended audience.	The intended audience, format, or communication approach is unclear, poorly justified, or insufficiently adapted to the audience's needs, knowledge, or context.	The intended audience and format are identified, with some attempt to adapt the material. Language, structure, style, accessibility, or level of detail may be inconsistent or only partly appropriate.	The chosen format is generally appropriate, and the communication is mostly clear, structured, and suitable for the intended audience. Some justification is provided for key adaptation choices.	The format, language, style, structure, accessibility, and level of detail are well adapted to the intended audience and context. Clearly justifies how the chosen approach meets audience needs. (S13, B5)	In addition to B-grade criteria: Adaptation choices show strong professional judgement, with the chosen format used effectively to communicate complex or specialist ideas.	In addition to A-grade criteria: The work demonstrates expert audience awareness, with communication choices that are highly appropriate, credible, and professionally persuasive.
Reflection and Professional Development (25%)	Not attempted, incoherent, or not reflective.	Reflection is very limited, generic, or mainly descriptive, with little attention to learning, professional relevance, personal goals, or future development.	Reflection addresses some required points and identifies at least one learning point from the process. Connections to professional development, personal goals, or future practice may be weak or underdeveloped.	Reflection is relevant and mostly clear, with some explanation of what was learned and how this relates to professional development. Some consideration of how the activity may inform future practice or personal goals.	Reflection is very clear and supported by appropriate examples. Meaningful learning identified and explained in relation to professional goals, Clear consideration of how the activity may inform future practice or personal goals. Adheres to 500-word limit within a +/- 10% tolerance.	In addition to B-grade criteria: Reflection shows strong self-awareness and professional judgement, including what was learned, what could be improved, and how this informs future development.	In addition to A-grade criteria: Reflection demonstrates mature, strategic insight into professional identity, reputation building, personal goals, and continuing development beyond the apprenticeship programme. Clear consideration given to how personal development can align with supporting others.